

SONG JOURNEY

"Seven Nation Army"

The White Stripes

Thread song — it appears in all 5 modules

One song, five layers. Each module adds a new skill to this song. Layer 6 is a bonus.

Form	Intro/Verse (riff ×4, quiet) → Chorus (same riff, big) → Solo (riff keeps looping)
The riff	E · E · G · E · D · C · B — seven notes, repeats every 2 bars
Rhythm	One riff note per beat. 4 beats per bar, 2 bars per cycle.
Key	E minor
Tempo	Practice at 60 BPM. The record is 123 BPM.

LAYER 1 Listen

Module 1

Listen to the song 3 times. This riff (a short musical phrase that repeats) never changes — only the volume around it does.

1. Listen once for the riff.
2. Listen once for the drums.
3. Listen once for how the chorus gets bigger without adding new notes.

Do it: Listen to the song once through.

Count how many times the riff repeats before the first chorus.

You've got it when: You can hum the main riff from memory.**Level up**

Listen again. Find the second chorus.

Name one other song built on a short repeating riff.

LAYER 2 Single Notes

Module 2

The riff lives on the A string, the one just below the low E string. That is where it sits at true pitch, so it sounds like the record.

The riff · A string · one note per beat

	E	E	G	E	D	C	B
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
A	--7---7---10---7--	--5---3---2---	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Play it: Play one note per beat at 60 BPM, without looking at the chart.

Say each note name out loud as you land it — E · E · G · E · D · C · B.

You've got it when: You can play the riff from memory at 60 BPM.

Level up

Play four laps (a lap = one full time through the riff) without stopping.
Then raise the tempo by 10 BPM.

LAYER 3 Power Chords

Module 3

Same riff you played as single notes. Now every root becomes a two-string power chord, one shape sliding along the A string.

Power chords · A string · one chord per riff note

	E5	E5	G5	E5	D5	C5	B5
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
D	--9-----9-----12-----9--	--7-----5-----4-----					
A	--7-----7-----10-----7--	--5-----3-----2-----					
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

Play it: Play one chord per riff note at 60 BPM, every string ringing clean.
Palm-mute the verse — rest the side of your strumming hand on the strings for a short, muted sound.
Let the strings ring louder in the chorus.

You've got it when: The loop runs at 60 BPM, every string ringing clean, no stops.

Level up

Play the same riff shape one octave up, on the D and G strings.
Then play one lap loud and one lap soft.

Octave-up power chords · D and G strings · one chord per riff note

	E5	E5	G5	E5	D5	C5	B5
e	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
G	--16-----16-----19-----16--	--14-----12-----11-----					
D	--14-----14-----17-----14--	--12-----10-----9-----					
A	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----
E	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----	-----

LAYER 4 Pentatonic Solo

Module 4

The riff is in E minor, so E minor pentatonic fits over every bar. Start with three notes only — Rule of 3 — and leave gaps of silence between notes.

This layer is a ladder with four rungs — each rung is one Module 4 skill. Climb them in order.

Rung 1 · Rule of 3**Three starting notes · E minor pentatonic, open position**

	E	G	A
e	-----	-----	-----
B	-----	-----	-----
G	-----	-----	-----
D	-----	-----	-----
A	-----	-----	-----
E	--0-----3-----	-----	-----

Play it: Loop the riff in your head and improvise 4 bars using these 3 notes.
End every phrase on E — that is home, the note the music rests on.

Rung 2 · The whole box

This is the whole box — E minor pentatonic, open position. Play it low string to high and back. Then improvise using any note in it. Keep landing on E.

The whole box · E minor pentatonic, open position

```

e | --0-----3----- |
B | --0-----3----- |
G | --0-----2----- |
D | --0-----2----- |
A | --0-----2----- |
E | --0-----3----- |

```

Rung 3 · Hammer-ons and pull-offs

h = hammer-on. Pick the first note, then tap the higher fret hard with your ring finger — two notes, one pick.

p = pull-off. Pick the fretted note, then flick that finger off the string so the open string sounds — two notes, one pick.

Hammer-ons and pull-offs · open-position box

```

      D E      G A      E D      E
e | ----- | ----- |
B | ----- | ----- |
G | -----0h2----- | ----- |
D | --0h2----- | --2p0-----2----- |
A | ----- | ----- |
E | ----- | ----- |

```

Play it: Practice each move slowly until the second note sounds clear.

Then add them to your three-note phrases.

Rung 4 · Two garage-rock licks

Two licks (short solo phrases) from the same box. Learn them exactly. Then change one note or the rhythm to make them your own.

Lick 1 · down and back up · lands on E

```

      G      E      D      E
e | --3-----0-----0-- |
B | -----3----- |
G | ----- |
D | ----- |
A | ----- |
E | ----- |

```

Lick 2 · descending · lands on E

```

      A      G      E
e | ----- |
B | ----- |
G | --2-----0----- |
D | -----2----- |
A | ----- |
E | ----- |

```

Play it: Learn each lick exactly.

Add the licks to your solos.

You've got it when: You have climbed all four rungs — dress-ups and licks show up in your solos.

Level up

Move the same box up 12 frets — same shape, one octave higher, same notes.

This is the pitch range used for the solo everyone knows from the record.

The box at fret 12 · E minor pentatonic, one octave up

```

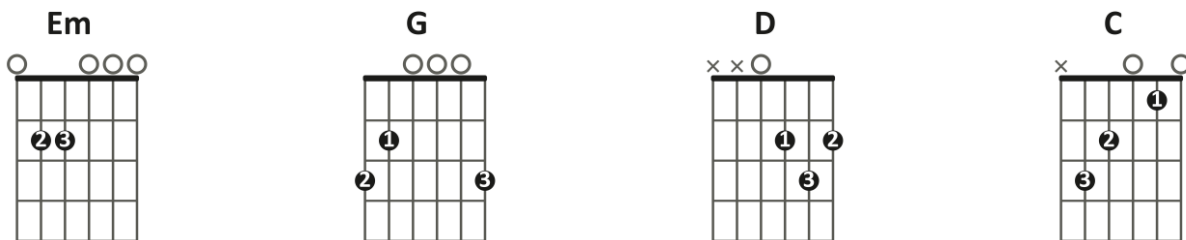
e | --12-----15----- |
B | --12-----15----- |
G | --12-----14----- |
D | --12-----14----- |
A | --12-----14----- |
E | --12-----15----- |

```

LAYER 5 Open Chords

Module 5

The simple singalong version. The riff's notes become a chord loop you can strum and sing over — a teaching arrangement built from chords you know.

**Singalong loop · open chords · one chord per beat**

```

| Em  Em  G  Em | D  C  C  (rest) |
1   2   3   4   1   2   3   4

```

Play it: Down-strum, one chord per beat.

Land every change on its beat — the same 2-bar cycle as Layers 2 and 3.

Hum the riff while you strum. Same notes, bigger sound.

You've got it when: The full loop runs at 60 BPM with changes on the beat.

Level up

Split strum: down, then down-up, on beats 2 and 4.

Try it on every chord in the loop.

Split strum · D · DU pattern · one bar per chord

```

| Em          | D          |
1       2   &       4   &
D       D   U       D   U

```

LAYER 6 The Slide Solo

Bonus

Bonus layer. Optional harder challenge. No score. Best once the Layer 2 riff plays from memory.

The slide solo is the Layer 2 riff again, two octaves up, played on the high e string with a slide (a metal or glass tube worn on a finger). No slide needed — the frets are your Layer 2 frets plus 5.

The solo · high e string · riff two octaves up

```

      E      E      G      E      D      C      B
e | --12---12---15---12- | --10---8---7----- |
B | ----- | ----- |
G | ----- | ----- |
D | ----- | ----- |
A | ----- | ----- |
E | ----- | ----- |

```

Play it: Play one note per beat at 60 BPM on the high e string alone.
Same pattern as Layer 2, five frets up: 12 · 12 · 15 · 12, then 10 · 8 · 7.
Slide your finger between frets instead of lifting it.

You've got it when: You can play the solo pattern from memory at 60 BPM, sliding between frets.

Level up

Slide into fret 12 from two frets below on each E.

This is the classic slide-guitar entrance.

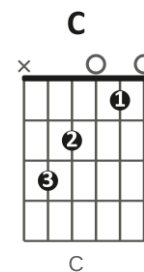
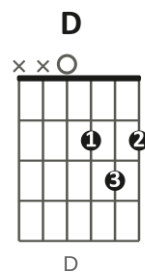
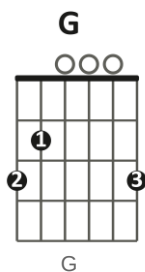
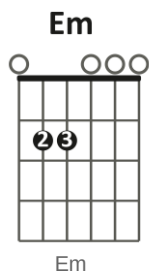
Slide into the riff · high e string

	E		E	G	E	D	C	B		
e		--10/12---	12---	15---	12-		--10---	8---	7-----	
B		-----	-----	-----	-----		-----	-----	-----	
G		-----	-----	-----	-----		-----	-----	-----	
D		-----	-----	-----	-----		-----	-----	-----	
A		-----	-----	-----	-----		-----	-----	-----	
E		-----	-----	-----	-----		-----	-----	-----	

FULL CHORD CHART

"Seven Nation Army"

The White Stripes

Key E minor**Tempo** 123 BPM · 4/4**Rhythm** One chord per riff note — the whole cycle is two bars**Form** Intro/Verse (riff ×4, quiet) → Chorus (same riff, big) → Solo (riff keeps looping) → repeat**Shapes you need****THE RIFF CYCLE**| **Em Em G Em** | **D C C (rest)** |

The whole song is this two-bar cycle. Riff notes: E · E · G · E · D · C · B. Beat 4 of bar 2 is a rest.

INTRO / VERSE**(riff cycle ×4)**

Quiet. Four times through the cycle.

CHORUS**(riff cycle, repeat)**

Same cycle, big and loud.

SOLO**(riff cycle, repeat)**

The riff keeps looping underneath the solo (Bonus layer: the riff two octaves up).

Teaching chart — simplified to match the Journey layers, not a note-for-note transcription. Chord names are what the class plays in standard tuning.

Seven Nation Army Chords by The White Stripes

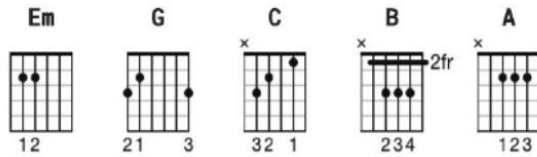


Difficulty: beginner

Tuning: E A D G B E

Key: Em

CHORDS



[Verse Riff]

```
G|-----|
D|-----5-----5-----5-----5-----| (x10)
A|-7--7--7-5-3-2--/-7--7--7-5-3-2--/-7--7--7-5-3-2--/-7--7--7-5-3-2-|
E|-0-----0-----0-----0-----|
```

[Pre/Post-Chorus Riff]

```
e|-----0-0-0-0-0-0-0-|
B|-----2-2-2-2-2-2-2-|
G|-4-4-4-4-4-4-4-2-2-2-2-2-2-2-|
D|-5-5-5-5-5-5-5-2-2-2-2-2-2-2-|
A|-5-5-5-5-5-5-5-0-0-0-0-0-0-0-|
E|-3-3-3-3-3-3-3-----|
```

(Bass)

```
G|-----|
D|-----|
A|-----0-0-0-0-0-0-0-|
E|-3-3-3-3-3-3-3-----|
```

[Chorus Riff]

(Gtr w/Distortion + 3 string slide)

```
e|-0-----|
B|-8--8/-12-\8-\7-\5--\4-|
G|-9--9/-12-\9-\7-\5--\4-|
D|-9--9/-12-\9-\7-\5--\4-|
A|-7--7/-10-\7-\5-\3--\2-|
E|-0-----|
```

(Bass)

G|-----|
 D|-----5-----|
 A|-7--7---7-5-3-2-|
 E|-0-----|

(Gtr)

e|-0-----|
 B|-8--8/-12-\-8-\7-\5-/7-\-5-\4-|
 G|-9--9/-12-\-9-\7-\5-/7-\-5-\4-|
 D|-9--9/-12-\-9-\7-\5-/7-\-5-\4-|
 A|-7--7/-10-\-7-\5-\3-/5-\-3-\2-|
 E|-0-----|

(Bass)

G|-----|
 D|-----5-----|
 A|-7--7---7-5-3-5-3-2-|
 E|-0-----|

[Verse 1]

 Em G C B
 I'm gonna fight 'em off
 Em G C B
 A seven nation army couldn't hold me back
 Em G C B
 They're gonna rip it off
 Em G C B
 Taking their time right behind my back
 Em G C
 And I'm talking to myself at night
 B Em G C B
 Because I can't forget
 Em G C
 Back and forth through my mind
 B Em G C B
 Behind a cigarette
 G A
 And a message coming from my eyes says leave it alone

[Instrumental Chorus]

Em G C B x4
 G A

[Interlude]

Em G C B x4

[Verse 2]

 Em G C B
 Don't wanna hear about it

Em G C B
Every single one's got a story to tell
Em G C B
Everyone knows about it
Em G C B
From the Queen of England to the hounds of Hell
Em G C B
And if I catch it coming back my way
Em G C B
I'm gonna serve it to you
Em G C B
And that ain't what you want to hear
Em G C B
But that's what I'll do
G A
And a feeling coming from my bones says find a home

[Solo]

Em G C B x8
G A

[Interlude]

Em G C B x4

[Verse 3]

Em G C B
I'm goin' to Wichita
Em G C B
Far from this opera, forever more
Em G C B
I'm gonna work the straw
Em G C B
Make the sweat drip out of every pore
Em G C
And I'm bleeding and I'm bleeding and I'm bleeding
B Em G C B
Right before the Lord
Em G C
All the words are gonna bleed from me
B Em G C B
And I will sing no more
G A
And the stains coming from my blood tell me go back home

[Instrumental Chorus]

Em G C B x4
Em

| / slide up

| \ slide down
